

QMS-001 — Document Control and Records Management Procedure

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1. PURPOSE AND SCOPE

This procedure establishes the controls required to ensure that all documents and records produced, received, or maintained by Overleaf Publishers Ltd are: created and approved by authorised personnel; clearly identified and version-controlled; available at the point of use; protected from unintended alteration or unauthorised access; and retained and disposed of in accordance with applicable legal and regulatory requirements.

Scope: all controlled documents including policies, procedures, work instructions, forms, templates, and externally generated regulatory documents referenced in the QMS; and all records generated as evidence of conformance or operational performance. Document reference: QMS-001.

2. DOCUMENT IDENTIFICATION AND REFERENCE NUMBERING

DOCUMENT TYPE	REFERENCE PREFIX
Quality Management policies and procedures	QMS-NNN
Health, safety, and wellbeing documents	HSW-NNN
Information security documents	ISP-NNN
Assessment and curriculum documents	ASS-NNN
Human resources and training documents	HRT-NNN
Environmental and sustainability documents	ENV-NNN
Legal and commercial documents	LEG-NNN
Operational forms and templates	FRM-NNN

Each document title page and footer carries: document reference, title, version number, effective date, review date, and approving authority.

3. DOCUMENT LIFECYCLE — CREATION TO APPROVAL

STAGE	ACTION AND RESPONSIBILITY
Draft	Author prepares document using the standard template. Draft marked 'DRAFT — Not for Use'.

Review	Author circulates to relevant stakeholders for comment. Comments collated and addressed.
Approval	Director reviews final draft and approves for issue. Signed approval record filed.
Issue	Approved document issued to recipients. Document Register updated. Previous version superseded.
Communication	Recipients notified. Key changes summarised in covering note for revisions.
Scheduled Review	Document reviewed on scheduled date or following a trigger event.
Retirement	Documents no longer required removed from active use and archived. Register updated.

4. MASTER DOCUMENT REGISTER

The Master Document Register is maintained by the Director and contains, for each controlled document: reference number; title; current version number; effective date; scheduled review date; document owner; physical/digital location; and distribution list. The Register is reviewed monthly for upcoming review dates.

5. VERSION CONTROL

Version numbering follows Major.Minor convention (e.g. 1.0, 1.1, 2.0).

- Major revision (X.0): fundamental change to policy intent, scope, or structure — full approval cycle required.
- Minor revision (X.Y): typographical correction or addition of clarifying detail — Director sign-off required.
- Draft documents numbered 0.1, 0.2 etc. — not issued for operational use.

6. REVIEW TRIGGERS AND SCHEDULE

DOCUMENT CATEGORY	STANDARD REVIEW CYCLE
Policies (all categories)	Annual
Operational procedures	Annual or following a significant process change
Forms and templates	Biennial or following a procedural change
Externally generated regulatory documents	On receipt of new edition or notification of amendment

Additional review triggers: regulatory or legislative change; audit finding; management review decision; incident/near-miss; stakeholder feedback identifying a discrepancy.

7. CONTROL OF EXTERNALLY GENERATED DOCUMENTS

Externally generated documents (HSE guidance, IIRSM/RoSPA standards, legislation) forming part of the QMS reference framework are: listed in the Document Register with source, version date, and verification date;

checked for updates at least annually; and replaced in the Register with the latest version upon update.

8. RECORDS RETENTION SCHEDULE

RECORD TYPE	MINIMUM RETENTION
Learner registration, progress, and assessment records	7 years from course completion
Digital waiver signatures	7 years from signature date
Complaint and appeal records	7 years
Incident reports and RIDDOR records	10 years (RIDDOR requirement for dangerous occurrences/disease)
Internal audit reports and corrective actions	7 years
Management review minutes	7 years
Supplier evaluation records	Duration of engagement + 3 years
Training and competence records	Duration of engagement + 7 years
Data breach records	7 years from discovery (ICO requirement)
Contract and commercial records	7 years from contract end (Companies Act requirement)
Health and safety risk assessments	Current version + previous 2 versions retained
Financial and VAT records	7 years (HMRC requirement)

9. STORAGE AND ACCESS

Documents and records are stored in the organisation's designated secure digital storage system (cloud-based, access-controlled per the Access Control Policy). Backup copies are maintained under the Business Continuity and Disaster Recovery Plan. Physical documents are stored in a locked cabinet. Records containing personal data are managed in accordance with the Data Protection Policy.

10. SECURE DISPOSAL

At the end of the retention period, records are reviewed for any ongoing legal or regulatory hold requirement. In the absence of a hold: digital records are securely deleted (cryptographically erased or overwritten); physical records are cross-shredded. A destruction certificate is filed in the Document Register. Records containing personal data are disposed of in accordance with UK GDPR requirements.

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